

Word family: **patient / patience / patiently / impatient / impatience / impatiently / patient**

Base word: patient

Related forms: patience, patiently, impatient, impatience, impatiently

Useful family extensions: patient with, have patience, lose patience, run out of patience, be patient, inpatient, outpatient

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “People often describe her as warm, **patient**, and quietly wise.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **patient** means **able to remain calm and tolerant when something takes time, when someone makes mistakes, or when a situation is difficult or frustrating**.

In your passage, your grandmother does not become irritated quickly. She listens, gives people time, and responds calmly.

繁體中文：**在等待、面對困難或別人犯錯時，能保持冷靜、不容易煩躁或發脾氣的；有耐性的**

中文翻譯：

> “People often describe her as warm, patient, and quietly wise.”

「人們常常形容她親切、**有耐性**，而且帶著一種安靜的智慧。」

Here:

patient = 面對等待、困難或別人的問題時仍能保持冷靜和包容，不容易失去耐性

1. **patient = able to wait calmly (等待時) — 有耐性的；耐心的**

This is one of the core meanings and closely matches your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “People often describe her as **patient**.”

「人們常常形容她很**有耐性**。」

Practice 2

> “You need to be ****patient**** while you wait for the results.”

「等待結果期間，你需要****有耐性一點****。」

Practice 3

> “She waited ****patiently**** for her turn.”

「她****耐心地****等候輪到自己。」

****patient** = 即使需要等待一段時間，也能保持冷靜，不因延誤而變得煩躁******

2. ****patient with + person** (對某人有耐性) — 對.....有耐性；包容******

Especially important in relationships.

Practice 4

> “She is very ****patient with**** her grandchildren.”

「她對孫兒女非常****有耐性****。」

Practice 5

> “Please be ****patient with**** him while he learns.”

「他正在學習，請對他****多一點耐性****。」

****patient with someone** = 即使某人學得慢、犯錯或需要較多時間，也能保持冷靜和包容******

This is very relevant to the grandmother described in your passage.

3. ****patient with + mistakes/problems** (面對問題有耐性) — 耐心處理******

Practice 6

> “Good teachers are ****patient with**** mistakes.”

「好的老師會****耐心看待學生的錯誤****。」

Practice 7

> “She remained ****patient**** despite all the difficulties.”

「儘管遇到很多困難，她仍然保持****耐性和冷靜****。」

****patient** = 面對困難、反覆問題或進展緩慢時，仍能忍耐並冷靜處理******

4. ****be patient** = 等一等；要有耐性******

A very common conversational expression.

Practice 8

> “Just ****be patient****. It will take a little time.”

「****耐心一點****，這需要一些時間。」

Practice 9

> “Be ****patient**** with yourself.”

「對自己****有耐性一點****。」

****be patient** = 不要急躁，給事情、別人或自己足夠時間******

5. ****patient** = willing to continue carefully for a long time (耐心細緻的) — 耐心的；不急於求成的******

This goes beyond merely waiting.

Practice 10

> “The work requires a ****patient**** approach.”

「這項工作需要一種****耐心而不急躁的處理方式****。」

Practice 11

> “She is a ****patient**** listener.”

「她是一個****很有耐性的聆聽者****。」

****patient = 願意長時間、細心而不急躁地處理某件事****

This is especially useful with:

- * patient teacher
- * patient listener
- * patient explanation
- * patient approach

6. ****patient — noun = person receiving medical treatment (病人) — 病人；患者****

This is a completely different lexical meaning.

Practice 12

> “The doctor examined the ****patient****.”

「醫生為****病人****進行檢查。」

Practice 13

> “The hospital treats hundreds of ****patients**** every day.”

「這間醫院每天治療數百名****患者****。」

****patient = 正在接受醫生、護士或其他醫療專業人員診斷、照顧或治療的人****

This is one of the clearest polysemy contrasts:

> ****a patient person**** = 有耐性的人

> ****a patient**** = 病人

7. ****patient care (醫療) — 病人照護；患者護理****

Practice 14

> “Good communication is essential to ****patient care****.”

「良好溝通對****病人照護****非常重要。」

Practice 15

> “The hospital is improving the quality of **patient care**.”

「醫院正在改善**患者照護質素**。」

patient care = 醫療人員為病人提供的診斷、治療、護理和支援

Here **patient** functions as a noun modifier meaning “related to patients.”

8. **patient safety** — 病人安全

Practice 16

> “The new system was introduced to improve **patient safety**.”

「新系統是為了提升**病人安全**而引入的。」

Practice 17

> “Medication errors can affect **patient safety**.”

「藥物錯誤可能影響**患者安全**。」

patient safety = 避免病人在接受醫療服務時受到可預防傷害的原則和措施

9. **inpatient** = 住院病人

A useful medical family extension.

Practice 18

> “He was admitted as an **inpatient**.”

「他被安排**住院治療** / 成為**住院病人**。」

Practice 19

> “The hospital provides both inpatient and outpatient services.”

「醫院同時提供**住院及門診服務**。」

inpatient = 需要入住醫院過夜或一段時間接受治療的病人

10. **outpatient = 門診病人**

Practice 20

> “She received treatment as an **outpatient**.”

「她以**門診病人**身份接受治療。」

Practice 21

> “Most minor procedures are now performed on **outpatients**.”

「現在很多較小型的醫療程序都以**門診形式**進行。」

outpatient = 到醫院 / 診所接受治療，但不需要入住過夜的病人

Compare:

* **inpatient** = 住院病人

* **outpatient** = 門診病人

11. **patience = ability to wait calmly (耐性) — 耐心；耐性**

The main noun form.

Practice 22

> “She has a lot of **patience**.”

「她非常**有耐性**。」

Practice 23

> “Learning a language requires **patience**.”

「學習語言需要**耐性**。」

patience = 在等待、困難或進展緩慢的情況下，仍能保持冷靜而不急躁的能力

Usually uncountable.

12. **patience with + person/situation (對.....的耐性) — 耐性；包容**

Practice 24

> “She has endless **patience with** children.”

「她對小孩有非常大的**耐性**。」

Practice 25

> “Thank you for your **patience with** us.”

「感謝你對我們的**耐心和包容**。」

patience with someone/something = 面對某人或某種反覆、困難的情況時所保持的耐性

13. **have patience — 有耐性**

Practice 26

> “You need to **have patience**.”

「你需要**有耐性**。」

Practice 27

> “Have a little **patience** and let her finish.”

「**耐心一點**，讓她先說完。」

have patience = 具備等待、忍耐或冷靜處理事情的能力

14. **lose patience — 失去耐性；開始不耐煩**

Practice 28

> “He began to **lose patience**.”

「他開始**失去耐性 / 變得不耐煩**。」

Practice 29

> “She rarely **loses patience** with her grandchildren.”

「她很少對孫兒女**失去耐性**。」

lose patience = 因等待、反覆問題或挫折而不再能保持冷靜和包容

15. **run out of patience** — 耐性用盡

A common figurative expression.

Practice 30

> “I’m beginning to **run out of patience**.”

「我的**耐性快要用盡了**。」

Practice 31

> “After waiting for two hours, everyone **ran out of patience**.”

「等了兩個小時後，大家都**失去耐性了**。」

run out of patience = 忍耐已接近極限，無法再繼續冷靜等待 / 容忍

The metaphor treats patience like a limited resource that can be used up.

16. **test someone's patience** — 考驗某人的耐性

Practice 32

> “The repeated delays **tested everyone's patience**.”

「一再延誤**考驗了大家的耐性**。」

Practice 33

> “His constant interruptions were beginning to **test her patience**.”

「他不斷插話，開始令她的**耐性受到考驗**。」

****test someone's patience = 令某人愈來愈難保持冷靜、不耐煩****

17. ****patience pays off — 耐心最終有回報****

A common expression.

Practice 34

> “Sometimes ****patience pays off****.”

「有時候****有耐性最終會有回報****。」

Practice 35

> “Her patience paid off when the project finally succeeded.”

「當項目最終成功時，她的****耐心終於得到回報****。」

****patience pays off = 願意等待和堅持最終帶來好的結果****

18. ****patiently = calmly without becoming annoyed (耐心地) — 耐心地****

The main adverb.

Practice 36

> “She listened ****patiently****.”

「她****耐心地****聆聽。」

Practice 37

> “He ****patiently**** explained the process again.”

「他****耐心地****再次解釋整個過程。」

****patiently = 在等待、解釋或面對困難時，以冷靜、不急躁的方式****

19. ****impatient = unable/unwilling to wait calmly (不耐煩的) — 沒耐性的；不耐煩的****

The main opposite form.

Practice 38

> “The children became **impatient** while waiting.”

「孩子們等候期間開始變得**不耐煩**。」

Practice 39

> “Don't be so **impatient**.”

「不要那麼**沒耐性 / 不耐煩**。」

impatient = 難以忍受等待、延誤或進展緩慢，容易感到煩躁的

20. **impatient with** + person/thing (對.....不耐煩) — 對.....失去耐性

Practice 40

> “He became **impatient with** the slow service.”

「他開始對緩慢的服務感到**不耐煩**。」

Practice 41

> “Try not to be **impatient with** beginners.”

「盡量不要對初學者**沒有耐性**。」

impatient with = 面對某人 / 某種情況時難以保持耐性，容易感到煩躁

21. **impatient to** + verb / for + event (急切想要.....) — 急於；迫不及待

An important second sense of **impatient**.

It does not always mean annoyed.

Practice 42

> “She was **impatient to hear** the news.”

「她**急著想知道 / 迫不及待想聽**那個消息。」

Practice 43

> “The children were **impatient for** the holiday to begin.”

「孩子們**迫不及待地等著假期開始**。」

impatient to/for = 非常渴望某件事快點發生，因此不願意繼續等待

This may express excitement rather than irritation.

22. **impatience = inability to wait calmly (不耐煩) — 不耐煩；缺乏耐性**

Practice 44

> “His **impatience** was obvious.”

「他的**不耐煩**非常明顯。」

Practice 45

> “She showed no **impatience** despite the delay.”

「儘管出現延誤，她沒有表現出任何**不耐煩**。」

impatience = 因等待、延誤或進展緩慢而產生的急躁 / 煩躁狀態

23. **impatience = eagerness for something to happen (急切) — 急切；迫不及待**

Practice 46

> “She waited with **impatience** for the results.”

「她**急切地 / 迫不及待地**等待結果。」

Practice 47

> “His **impatience** to begin was obvious.”

「他那種**急著開始、迫不及待的心情**非常明顯。」

****impatience = 強烈希望某件事立即發生，不想再等下去的急切感****

24. ****impatiently = in an annoyed/eager way (不耐煩 / 急切地) — 不耐煩地；急切地****

Practice 48

> “He tapped his fingers ****impatiently****.”

「他****不耐煩地****用手指敲著桌面。」

Practice 49

> “She waited ****impatiently**** for the announcement.”

「她****迫不及待地****等候公布結果。」

****impatiently = 以缺乏耐性、煩躁，或急切希望事情快點發生的方式****

Important distinction: ****patient vs patience****

****patient****

= adjective

> “She is patient.”

「她很有耐性。」

****patience****

= noun

> “She has a lot of patience.”

「她很有耐性。」

So:

> ****be patient**** 

> ****have patience**** 

Not:

> “She is patience.” ❌

Important distinction: **patient — adjective vs patient — noun**

This is the biggest polysemy contrast.

patient — adjective

> “She is patient with children.”

= 她對小孩很有耐性。

patient — noun

> “The doctor spoke to the patient.”

= 醫生跟病人說話。

Same spelling, completely different lexical meaning.

Important distinction: **patient vs calm**

patient

focuses on:

> being able to tolerate waiting, difficulties, repetition, or other people's mistakes.

calm

means:

> not nervous, excited, angry, or emotionally agitated.

Someone can be calm in an emergency but impatient with waiting.

So they overlap, but are not synonyms.

Important distinction: **patient vs tolerant**

patient

often concerns:

- * waiting
- * slow progress
- * mistakes
- * repeated explanation

tolerant

usually means:

> willing to accept differences, behaviour, beliefs, or conditions one may not personally prefer.

A patient teacher and a tolerant society involve different concepts.

Important distinction: **patient vs understanding**

patient

= does not become frustrated quickly.

understanding

= recognizes and sympathizes with another person's situation or reasons.

Your grandmother may be both:

> patient and understanding

but the qualities are distinct.

Important distinction: **patient vs persistent**

patient

= willing to wait without becoming irritated.

persistent

= continues trying despite difficulty or failure.

A person can be:

> persistent but impatient

if they keep trying but dislike waiting.

Important distinction: ****patient vs passive****

This is important because patience does not mean doing nothing.

****patient****

= willing to give something sufficient time without unnecessary frustration.

****passive****

= not taking active action or initiative.

A patient person can still be very active and decisive.

Important distinction: ****patience vs endurance****

****patience****

focuses on:

> tolerating delay, difficulty, repetition, or frustration calmly.

****endurance****

focuses on:

> continuing through physical or mental hardship over time.

So:

> waiting quietly requires patience

while:

> running a marathon requires endurance.

Important distinction: **patience vs tolerance**

patience

= ability to remain calm when something is slow/difficult.

tolerance

= ability/willingness to accept something, especially differences or unpleasant conditions.

There is overlap, but **patience** strongly involves time and frustration.

Important distinction: **impatient — annoyed vs eager**

This is especially important.

impatient with someone

= irritated because they are too slow or difficult.

> “She became impatient with him.”

「她開始對他不耐煩。」

impatient to do something

= very eager for something to happen.

> “She was impatient to begin.”

「她迫不及待想開始。」

So **impatient** can express:

* negative irritation

* strong eagerness

depending on construction.

Important distinction: **patiently vs slowly**

patiently

describes the person's emotional attitude:

> without irritation.

slowly

describes speed.

> “She explained it slowly.”

= 她慢慢解釋。

> “She explained it patiently.”

= 她很有耐性地解釋。

The explanation can be both slow and patient, but these words describe different qualities.

Important distinction: **patient with vs patient about**

For learners, the safest and most common interpersonal pattern is:

> **patient with + person/problem**

> “Be patient with her.”

When talking about waiting for an outcome, English often simply uses:

> **be patient**

rather than forcing **patient about**.

Important distinction: **inpatient vs impatient**

These look and sound similar but are completely different.

inpatient

= a hospital patient who stays overnight

「住院病人」

impatient

= unable to wait calmly

「不耐煩的」

This is a high-value spelling distinction.

Important distinction: **outpatient vs inpatient**

inpatient

= admitted to hospital and stays there

outpatient

= receives treatment without staying overnight

Both derive from the **patient = medical patient** branch, not from **patient = 有耐性**.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **patient / patience** family:

- * **patient — calm/tolerant** = 有耐性的
- * **patient with someone** = 對某人有耐性
- * **be patient** = 耐心一點
- * **patient listener/teacher** = 有耐性的聆聽者 / 老師
- * **patient — medical noun** = 病人 / 患者
- * **patient care** = 病人照護
- * **patient safety** = 病人安全
- * **inpatient** = 住院病人
- * **outpatient** = 門診病人
- * **patience** = 耐性
- * **have patience** = 有耐性
- * **lose patience** = 失去耐性

* **run out of patience** = 耐性用盡
 * **test someone's patience** = 考驗某人的耐性
 * **patiently** = 耐心地
 * **impatient** = 不耐煩的 / 急切的
 * **impatient with** = 對.....不耐煩
 * **impatient to/for** = 迫不及待
 * **impatience** = 不耐煩 / 急切
 * **impatiently** = 不耐煩地 / 迫不及待地

As in the curation reference, useful derivatives and compounds belong in the practical family sweep, but their meanings should be labelled accurately rather than presented as additional meanings of the adjective **patient** itself.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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patient — waiting calmly	即使需要等待，也能保持冷靜而不因延誤變得煩躁
patient with someone	面對某人的錯誤、緩慢或需要時，仍能保持冷靜和包容
patient — difficulty/repetition	面對困難、反覆問題或進展緩慢時仍能耐心處理
patient listener/approach	願意花時間細心處理 / 聆聽，而不急於求成
patient — medical noun	正在接受醫療專業人員診斷、照顧或治療的人
patient care	醫療人員為病人提供的治療、護理和支援
patient safety	避免患者在接受醫療服務時受到可預防傷害的措施 / 原則
inpatient	入住醫院一段時間接受治療的病人
outpatient	接受醫療服務但不需要入住醫院過夜的病人
patience	面對等待、困難或進展緩慢時仍能保持冷靜的能力
patience with	面對某人 / 某情況時所保持的耐性和包容
have patience	具備等待和冷靜忍耐的能力
lose patience	因等待、反覆問題或挫折而不再能保持冷靜
run out of patience	忍耐已接近或達到極限
test someone's patience	令某人愈來愈難保持耐性
patiently	以冷靜、不急躁並願意等待的方式
impatient — annoyed	難以忍受等待 / 緩慢，因此容易感到煩躁
impatient with	對某人或某情況難以保持耐性
impatient to/for	非常渴望某事盡快發生，因此迫不及待
impatience — irritation	因等待或進展緩慢而產生的不耐煩和急躁
impatience — eagerness	強烈希望某件事立即發生、不願再等的急切感

For your original sentence

> “People often describe her as warm, **patient**, and quietly wise.”

The exact meaning is:

****patient = 面對等待、困難、別人的錯誤或需要時，仍能保持冷靜、有耐性和包容****

Therefore:

> ****a patient person****

= ****「一個不容易不耐煩、願意給別人時間，而且能冷靜包容的人」****

This also fits the later description of your grandmother:

> “She never judges me too quickly... Instead, she listens first...”

That behaviour reinforces the ****patient**** sense: she does not rush to react or criticize.

The most important polysemy contrast is:

> ****She is patient.****

> = 她很有耐性。

versus:

> ****She is a patient.****

> = 她是一名病人。

And the most important family contrast is:

> ****patient**** = 有耐性的

> ****patience**** = 耐性

> ****patiently**** = 耐心地

> ****impatient**** = 不耐煩的 / 迫不及待的

> ****impatience**** = 不耐煩 / 急切